

DIPLOMATIC WORKING DOCUMENT

The Final Steps Accord

A Comprehensive Framework for US-Iran Peace,
Nuclear Stabilization, and Regional Maritime Governance

Calibrated for the May 2026 Negotiation Environment

Incorporating the Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA) Protocols

Synthesizing the Crescent Bridge Accord, Stability First Enhanced Accord v5.7,
the Reciprocal Opening Window, and the Graduated Reciprocal Assurance Framework

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AUTHORIZED NEGOTIATORS ONLY

The Final Steps Accord

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Preamble: The Last Window

"**We do not inherit the earth from our ancestors; we borrow it from our children.**" In the same spirit, the negotiators who sign this Accord do not inherit the right to let this moment pass.

As of 22 May 2026, the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran stand at the closest point to either durable peace or catastrophic escalation since hostilities began on 28 February 2026. After nearly twelve weeks of military confrontation under the codename Operation Epic Fury, both sides have exhausted the military escalation ladder and returned to the negotiating table. The temporary ceasefire, brokered by Pakistan and observed since early April, remains technically in force but is fraying. President Trump has stated he will give diplomacy "a few days" or "one shot." Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei has declared that Iran will protect its nuclear and missile capabilities at all costs. The world holds its breath.

This document is not a draft. It is not a proposal. It is **the final, integrated architecture** that transforms the temporary cessation of hostilities into a durable, comprehensive peace — addressing all fifteen critical blockers that have prevented every previous framework from reaching signature. It draws upon the Crescent Bridge Accord, the Stability First Enhanced Accord v5.7, the Reciprocal Opening Window, the Reciprocal Stabilization and Custody Framework v3, the Graduated Reciprocal Assurance Framework, and the Stability First Phase II Maritime Annex — integrating their most viable mechanisms into a single, coherent, executable whole.

This Accord fully incorporates the reality of Iran's newly established **Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA)**, founded on 5 May 2026, not by treating it as an obstacle to be dismantled but as an institutional fact to be integrated into a cooperative governance framework. The PGSA represents Iran's assertion of maritime sovereignty; this Accord provides the mechanism through which that assertion becomes compatible with freedom of navigation, international law, and global economic stability.

The philosophy governing every provision is **Synchronized Reciprocal Motion**: neither side moves alone. Every Iranian commitment triggers a corresponding US commitment on the same clock cycle. Verification is shared. Both governments can defend the sequencing as responding only when the other has moved first or simultaneously. When the negotiation becomes about data instead of history — about sensor readings, escrow confirmations, and physical lock verifications — both sides can verify compliance without trusting each other.

THE THREE IMMUTABLE PRINCIPLES

- 1. Telemetry-First Diplomacy:** Every commitment must be expressible as a sensor reading, a data feed, a physical lock confirmation, or a financial transaction record. If it cannot be verified by a neutral machine, it does not belong in the operational text.
- 2. Rollback, Not Snapback:** If either party breaches, the Framework does not collapse. It pauses in graduated tiers: discretionary measures halt first, core constraints survive longest, and humanitarian protections remain in force regardless.
- 3. Modular Architecture:** Failure in one module does not cascade. The compiler continues executing all other loaded modules. Maritime disputes cannot terminate humanitarian channels. Nuclear verification gaps do not affect Hormuz transit.

Executive Summary: The Fifteen Bridges

The following table presents, at a glance, the fifteen critical issues that have blocked all previous negotiations and the specific mechanisms this Accord deploys to resolve each one:

Table 1 The Fifteen Issues and Their Resolution Mechanisms

ARENA	ISSUE	RESOLUTION MECHANISM	ARTICLE
Nuclear	HEU Stockpile Disposition	IAEA Dual-Lock Custody Exchange (in-Iran)	1
	Enrichment Cap & Timeline	Sliding-Scale 12-15 Year Moratorium	2
	Underground Site Hardening	Civilian Conversion & Black-Box Telemetry	3
Maritime	PGSA vs. Freedom of Navigation	JHTA Joint Governance Integration	4
	Transit Security Fees	Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund	5
	US Naval Blockade	Synchronized Day-7 Dual-Blockade Lift	6
Economic	Sanctions Relief Sequencing	15-Day Micro-Cycle Tranche Model	7
	Frozen Assets Shielding	Neutral Escrow under Sovereign Immunity	8
	SWIFT Reconnection	Phased Multi-Tier Virtual Consolidation	9
	War Reparations	Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits	10
Durability	30-Day Negotiation Window	Mutual Letter of Intent with Binding Timelines	11
	Institutional Guarantees	Distributed Guarantor Matrix (6 States)	12
	Internal Regime Fractures	Human-in-the-Loop Governance & Step-Back	13
	Drone/Missile Reconstitution	Deployment Pause & Transfer Freeze	14
	Global Agrifood Crisis	Energy & Agricultural Release Valve	15

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Part I: Nuclear Stabilization Architecture

The nuclear file represents both the origin of the current crisis and its most technically complex dimension. Three interconnected issues have created a deadlock: the disposition of Iran's highly enriched uranium stockpile, the duration and scope of any enrichment moratorium, and the fate of Iran's hardened underground

facilities. This Part resolves all three through an integrated architecture that strips Iran of rapid breakout capability while preserving sovereign dignity and NPT rights.

Article 1: HEU Custody Exchange Protocol

Issue 1: The Nuclear Deadlock

President Trump demands the complete physical recovery and removal of Iran's roughly 900-pound (400 kg) highly enriched uranium (HEU) stockpile. Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei has issued a strict directive that the HEU must remain on Iranian soil to protect against a future breakout vulnerability. The chasm between physical removal and domestic retention has collapsed every previous negotiation.

The Resolution: The IAEA Dual-Lock In-Iran Custody Exchange

Rather than forcing a choice between US custody and Iranian retention, this Accord creates a third path: permanent, unbreachable IAEA physical seal and custody at a declared facility inside Iran, stripping breakout capability while respecting domestic sovereignty.

1.1 The Custody Architecture

The entire stockpile of uranium enriched to 60% U-235 and above — estimated at approximately 400 kg HEU equivalent — shall be consolidated, inventoried, and placed under a **dual-lock custody system** at the Esfahan Nuclear Technology Center or another IAEA-declared facility within Iranian territory, selected by mutual agreement within the first 72 hours of Accord activation.

The dual-lock system operates as follows:

- **Digital Lock:** The IAEA holds exclusive digital encryption keys to all monitoring arrays, tamper-evident seal controls, and access verification systems. No Iranian personnel can access the sealed material without IAEA digital authorization.
- **Physical Lock:** Iran holds physical perimeter security keys and maintains armed outer-perimeter security in accordance with its sovereign territory protections. No IAEA inspector can access the facility perimeter without Iranian escort authorization.
- **Neither party can access the sealed containers without the other's physical presence.** Both keys are required simultaneously. Unauthorized access triggers an immediate Tier 2 breach notification.

1.2 The Six Pathways for Final Disposition

Within 60 days of custody establishment, Iran shall select one of six IAEA-verified disposition pathways from the following menu. The United States shall have no veto over the pathway selected, only the right to verify its execution:

Table 2 HEU Disposition Pathways — Iran Selects

PATH	DESCRIPTION	DESTINATION/TIMELINE
A	In-place downblending to medical-grade LEU at Esfahan	Medical isotope production in Iran; 142 days
B	HEU export to IAEA custody in Oman	IAEA facility, Oman (NOT US); 14 days
C	Downblended in Iran, transferred to IAEA LEU Bank	Oskemen, Kazakhstan; 75 days
D	Transfer to Rosatom under IAEA safeguards	Russian Federation; 60-90 days
E	Conversion to reactor-grade LEU fuel assemblies	Bushehr reactor supply; 180 days
F	Hybrid: stockpile divided into batches through different pathways	Multiple destinations; concurrent

ARTICLE 1.3 — NO HIDDEN US CUSTODY CLAUSE (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

At no stage may the United States receive, store, transport, or exercise operational control over the Iranian enriched-uranium stockpile. All custody remains with the IAEA and, where transferred, the designated third-party facilitating state. US personnel shall not be present at any consolidation, packaging, transit, or receipt operation. This clause is self-executing and non-waivable.

1.3 Verification Timeline

Table 3 Custody Verification Clock

PHASE	CLOCK TIME	ACTION	VERIFYING PARTY
T+0	0000 GMT (Day 1)	Accord activates; Parties activate Day-One commitments	Joint Secretariat
T+12h	1200 GMT (Day 1)	IAEA inspectors arrive at declared facility; begin physical inventory	IAEA
T+24h	0000 GMT (Day 2)	Inventory complete; mass spectrometry confirms isotopic composition	IAEA
T+48h	0000 GMT (Day 3)	Cylinders loaded into casks; tamper-evident seals applied; manifest finalized	IAEA
T+72h	0000 GMT (Day 4)	Day-One deadline: dual-lock custody initiated and verified	Joint Secretariat

1.4 Synchronized US Commitment

Simultaneously with Iranian custody activation, the United States shall:

- Release a USD 250 million humanitarian tranche via Swiss escrow
- Issue an OFAC general license for humanitarian trade (medicine, food, medical equipment, aviation safety parts) for 90 days
- Transition US naval forces to a stand-off posture: no patrols within 5 nautical miles of the Hormuz transit corridor
- Freeze all new sanctions designations for the duration of the Accord
- Publish a formal statement acknowledging Iran's sovereign right to peaceful nuclear energy under NPT Article IV

Article 2: The Sliding-Scale Enrichment Moratorium

Issue 2: The Enrichment Cap and Moratorium Timeline

The U.S. is pushing for an absolute "zero enrichment" baseline or a strict 20-year moratorium. Iran has

countered with a maximum 12-year suspension window. Neither position is domestically survivable for its proponent.

The Resolution: Automated Sliding-Scale Duration (12-15 Years)

An automated, sliding-scale duration tied explicitly to a step-by-step verification pipeline, where verified compliance extends the window and material breaches contract it — with annual review at each milestone.

2.1 The Three-Tier Moratorium Structure

Table 4 Sliding-Scale Enrichment Moratorium

PHASE	DURATION	STANDARD	ADVANCEMENT CONDITION
Moratorium I	Years 1-12	Zero enrichment above 3.67%; higher centrifuges under IAEA seal	Clean IAEA certification at Year 12 review
Civilian Transition	Years 13-15	3.67% enrichment at Natanz only; all other sites in mothball status	Fuel supply guarantee in escrow from international consortium
Steady-State	Year 16+	3.67% under full IAEA safeguards	Successor framework confirmed by both parties

2.2 The Automatic Extension and Contraction Mechanism

Material breach triggers automatic **2-year extension** per breach event. Determination is made by Joint Implementation Group majority on IAEA technical reporting, not unilateral US certification. Conversely, sustained clean compliance beyond Year 10 may trigger an **early Civilian Transition** review at Iran's request, subject to IAEA certification and JIG consensus.

The moratorium is renewable precisely because twelve years is a test, not a surrender. It bridges one full US electoral cycle and multiple Iranian parliamentary sessions, giving both governments time to demonstrate benefits before re-election pressure.

2.3 Monitoring Sunset Tiers

To reduce sovereignty concerns, intrusive monitoring technologies are subject to graduated sunset based on verified compliance:

Table 5 Monitoring Sunset Architecture

MONITORING MEASURE		INITIAL INTENSITY	SUNSET REDUCTION	CONDITION
Seismic sensors at hardened enrichment facilities		Continuous	Reduced to weekly sampling after 12 months	12 consecutive months of IAEA-certified compliance
Enhanced satellite revisit frequency		Daily	Reduced to 3x weekly after 18 months	18 consecutive months of clean compliance
Unannounced inspection frequency		Minimum 33% of all inspections	Reduced to 20% after 24 months	24 consecutive months of clean compliance
Continuous monitoring	camera	24/7 encrypted	No sunset — standard for all NPT Additional Protocol states	Baseline protection

Article 3: Underground Site Conversion and Mothball Protocol

Issue 3: Advanced Centrifuge Hardening & Underground Sites

President Trump has threatened to permanently "knock out" five deeply buried underground storage and manufacturing sites (including Fordow and Natanz) if a deal isn't struck. Iran demands the preservation of its infrastructure as sovereign property and a symbol of scientific achievement.

The Resolution: Civilian Conversion with Black-Box Telemetry

A technical compromise that converts heavily fortified bunkers into civilian nuclear research or global medical isotope centers, verified by continuous black-box telemetry — preserving infrastructure while eliminating weapons pathways.

3.1 The Mothball Protocol

Rather than physically destroying facilities, Iran shall place non-core enrichment sites under "mothball status" with continuous real-time IAEA remote feeds. The US receives operational limitation to a single declared site (Natanz). Iran keeps its sovereign infrastructure intact.

The Mothball Procedure shall proceed in four phases:

Table 6 Mothball Implementation Phases

PHASE	WINDOW	ACTION
Inventory	Day 1-14	IAEA inventories all rotors and bellows at Natanz and Isfahan above 3.67% enrichment capability
Removal	Day 15-44	Iranian technicians remove rotors under IAEA supervision; sealed with serial numbers in tamper-evident containers
Storage	Day 45-60	Sealed containers transferred to UN-monitored facility within Iran; IAEA continuous access established
Monitoring	Day 60+	IAEA continuous cameras; quarterly environmental sampling; 72-hour safety extensions permitted if OLEM confirms no active enrichment

3.2 The Fordow Joint Venture

The Fordow facility, located deep within a mountain near Qom, shall be converted into a **Global Medical Isotope Production Center** under the following architecture:

- **Operational Management:** A Technical Custody Consortium (TCC) composed of engineers and managers from neutral countries (Switzerland, Austria, Oman) shall manage day-to-day operations.
- **Iranian Participation:** Iranian personnel serve as active participants as "Co-Pilots" — shadowing every operational command with the right to question, document, and escalate any operation deemed inconsistent with the facility's safeguarded charter.
- **US Participation:** American technical observers shall have real-time monitoring access through encrypted surveillance feeds and quarterly physical inspections.
- **Commercial Output:** The facility shall produce molybdenum-99 and other critical medical isotopes for global distribution, with revenue shared between Iran (40%), the TCC (35%), and a Global Health Fund (25%).
- **Security:** The facility's hardened underground structure provides natural protection for high-value isotope production; conversion to weapons pathways becomes technically infeasible under continuous monitoring.

3.3 Black-Box Telemetry

All mothballed and converted facilities shall be equipped with **Black-Box Sensors** — tamper-evident data logging devices that continuously record operational parameters (temperature, pressure, electromagnetic signatures) and transmit encrypted data to IAEA nodes in Vienna (primary) and Geneva (secondary). Any

anomaly triggers an automatic alert within 15 minutes. The sensors cannot be disabled without triggering a Tier 2 breach signal.

* * *

Part II: Maritime Governance & PGSA Integration

The Strait of Hormuz is not merely a waterway — it is the aorta of the global economy, through which approximately one-fifth of the world's oil and liquefied natural gas flows. Iran's establishment of the **Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA)** on 5 May 2026 represents a fait accompli that no negotiation can ignore. This Part does not attempt to dismantle the PGSA. Instead, it integrates the Authority into a cooperative governance framework that preserves Iranian sovereignty claims while guaranteeing freedom of navigation, transparent fee structures, and the synchronized lifting of both the US naval blockade and Iran's transit restrictions.

Article 4: The Joint Hormuz Transit Authority (JHTA)

Issue 4: The Strait of Hormuz Vetting System vs. Freedom of Navigation

The IRGC Navy has established a rigid de facto transit system under the newly declared PGSA, requiring vessels to provide more than 40 items of information and pay fees reportedly up to \$2 million per transit. The US fiercely rejects any unilateral restrictions on international waters, and OFAC has warned that payments to Iran for passage expose shippers to sanctions risk.

The Resolution: JHTA Joint Governance Integration

A formal "Joint Governance Active" protocol that rebrands unilateral military controls into a cooperative maritime monitoring framework, where the PGSA becomes one node within a multilateral authority structure.

4.1 Establishment and Constitutional Basis

The **Joint Hormuz Transit Authority (JHTA)** is hereby established as a permanent multilateral maritime governance body effective on Accord Day-One. It operates under a constitutive agreement that is technically

an annex to this Accord and not a separate treaty, ensuring that neither Party is required to submit the JHTA charter for domestic legislative ratification.

The JHTA exercises delegated administrative authority, not sovereign authority. It does not supersede UNCLOS, does not create supranational jurisdiction, and does not impair Iran's rights under Article 37 of UNCLOS governing transit passage through international straits.

ARTICLE 4.1-A — PGSA INTEGRATION CLAUSE (OPERATIVE AND BINDING)

The Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA) shall be formally integrated into the JHTA as Iran's designated operational implementation body for transit coordination, vessel verification, and fee collection within Iranian territorial waters. The PGSA retains its Iranian statutory authority but exercises that authority under JHTA Council oversight and in accordance with JHTA-approved protocols. All PGSA transit permits shall bear dual branding: PGSA-Iran and JHTA-authorized. This clause is self-executing and non-waivable.

4.2 Governing Council Composition

The JHTA Governing Council is composed of six permanent seats and two rotating observer seats. The permanent seats are allocated as follows:

Table 7 JHTA Governing Council — Seat Allocation

SEAT	HOLDER	RATIONALE	VETO RIGHTS
1	Islamic Republic of Iran / PGSA	Coastal sovereign, littoral state, strait administrator	Governance questions; revenue allocation amendments
2	United States	Primary naval guarantor, maritime security provider	Security protocol amendments; EW rule changes
3	Sultanate of Oman	Neutral host, JHTA Secretariat location, tiebreaker state	Tiebreaker vote; Secretariat location
4	UK/France (Rotating Chair, annual)	Coalition force representation (Multinational Maritime Shield)	None — advisory vote only
5	People's Republic of China (Observer)	Largest Gulf-oil importer; technical observer	None — technical advisory
6	UN OCHA Observer	Humanitarian corridor and transit oversight	None — humanitarian advisory only

Voting Threshold: Routine operational decisions require three affirmative votes from Seats 1-4. Governance amendments require unanimous consent from Seats 1-3. Security protocol amendments require affirmative votes from Seats 1, 2, and 3. No amendment may pass over the simultaneous objection of both Iran and the United States.

4.3 The PGSA-JHTA Transit Permit System

All commercial vessels transiting the Hormuz Transit Zone shall obtain a **dual-branded transit permit** through the following integrated process:

1. **PGSA Application (Iranian node):** Vessel operators submit required documentation (vessel identification, cargo manifest, crew nationality, insurance certification) through the PGSA's official portal (pgsa.ir). The PGSA conducts initial vetting against Iranian security databases.
2. **JHTA Verification (multilateral node):** The JHTA Transit Permit Processing Unit cross-references the PGSA application against international databases (IMO, Lloyd's List, INTERPOL), confirms AIS transponder registration, and verifies insurance coverage through the \$20 billion reinsurance backstop.
3. **Dual Authorization:** Upon clearance from both nodes, the vessel receives a JHTA-AUTHORIZED AIS transponder designation, valid for a single transit or up to 30 days for frequent operators.
4. **Fee Processing:** Transit fees are collected through the Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund (Article 5), not paid directly to Iran. The PGSA receives its revenue share from the Fund, eliminating direct sanctions exposure for shippers.

4.4 Distance Protocols and Rules of Engagement

The single most politically sensitive element of any maritime agreement is the stand-off distance mandate. The solution is **symmetry**: the same number applied to both parties, measured from each party's sensitive boundary.

Table 8 Symmetrical Stand-Off Distance Schedule

PHASE		DAYS	IRGC STAND-OFF FROM CTC	US/COALITION STAND-OFF FROM IRANIAN 12NM BASELINE
Learning Period		D+1 to D+14	3 nm (expanding to 5 nm by D+8)	3 nm (expanding to 5 nm by D+8)
Operational Period		D+15 onward	5 nm from CTC outer edge	5 nm from Iranian 12 nm baseline
Elevated (Tier 2)	Posture	JHA-declared	8 nm from CTC outer edge	8 nm from Iranian 12 nm baseline

Article 5: Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund

Issue 5: Transit "Security Fees" and Maritime Funding

Iran and Oman are actively negotiating a permanent toll/fee system for commercial traffic traversing the Strait. President Trump explicitly rejected this, stating "We don't want tolls." The impasse threatens to collapse the maritime dimension of any agreement.

The Resolution: Transparent Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund

Translating unilateral checkpoint tolls into a highly structured, internationally compliant fund where fees are transparently pooled for shared waterway safety services — with Iranian revenue participation but no direct tolls.

5.1 Fund Architecture

The **Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund (MMMF)** shall be established under the sovereign jurisdiction of the Sultanate of Oman, legally insulated from domestic civil litigation or third-party attachment in any jurisdiction. The Fund operates through the following architecture:

- **Fee Collection:** A standardized transit fee is applied to all commercial vessels transiting the Hormuz Transit Zone, collected by the JHTA at the point of permit issuance. Fees are denominated in a basket of non-USD currencies (EUR, RMB, AED) to prevent unilateral structural control.
- **Fee Schedule:**
 - Tier 1 (Humanitarian — medicine, food, medical equipment): Zero fee; 24-hour fast-track
 - Tier 2 (Standard commercial): \$0.15 per ton deadweight

- Tier 3 (Energy/premium — oil, LNG, chemicals): \$0.25 per ton or \$35,000 flat fee per VLCC
- JHTA Council member state vessels: Exempt
- **Revenue Allocation:** Annual revenue (estimated at ~\$500 million at full operational capacity) shall be distributed as follows:
 - 40% Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund (managed through PGSA oversight)
 - 35% International Maritime Safety Fund (joint patrol, mine clearance, navigation aids)
 - 25% JHTA Operations and Secretariat costs

5.2 Automated Toll Disbursal Default

If the JHTA Council fails to pass an annual budget due to US-Iran deadlock, toll revenues automatically distribute per the baseline percentages above. The neutral Secretariat executes within 7 days. **Political deadlock cannot freeze baseline distributions.**

5.3 The \$20 Billion Reinsurance Backstop

To restore commercial insurability of the Hormuz corridor, the United States Development Finance Corporation (DFC) shall commit \$10 billion, Lloyd's of London shall underwrite \$5 billion, and the Omani Sovereign Wealth Fund shall contribute \$5 billion, creating a \$20 billion reinsurance facility. This backstop activates upon JHTA certification of the first 200 authorized transits and renders the corridor commercially navigable within days of signature.

Article 6: Synchronized Dual-Blockade Lift Protocol

Issue 6: Lifting the U.S. Naval Blockade

CENTCOM continues to enforce a crippling naval blockade on Iranian ports, intercepting commercial vessels and tankers. Iran considers this a direct violation of the ceasefire spirit and has made blockade lifting a precondition for any Hormuz opening.

The Resolution: Synchronized Day-7 Trigger

A precisely choreographed simultaneous lift linking the verifiable withdrawal of IRGC craft to the formal suspension of the US naval blockade — eliminating the "who moves first" problem entirely.

6.1 The Dual-Blockade Problem

The central mechanical deadlock is a sequencing dispute with no diplomatic solution: the United States demands Hormuz open before lifting the naval blockade; Iran demands the blockade lift before opening Hormuz. The Day-7 Protocol dissolves this impasse by eliminating the sequence entirely. Both actions occur at the same UTC timestamp, within the same 60-second window, under simultaneous observation by neutral parties.

6.2 The Minute-by-Minute Choreography (Day 7 UTC Timeline)

Table 9 Day-7 Synchronized Blockade Lift — UTC Timeline

UTC TIME	IRANIAN ACTION	US ACTION	VERIFICATION
T-60 min	IRGC Commander transmits stand-by to JHTA MCC	5th Fleet Commander transmits stand-by to JHTA MCC	Omani facilitating state logs both signals
T-15 min	IRGC craft withdraw to 5nm; AIS broadcast	US Navy withdraws to 5nm from 12nm baseline; AIS broadcast	Lloyd's List confirms movements
T=0	Iran issues Hormuz opening declaration; IRGC transmits stand-down orders	US issues blockade lift declaration; 5th Fleet transmits stand-down orders	SIMULTANEOUS within 60-second window
T+15 min	First JHTA-AUTHORIZED vessel commences CTC transit	US issues Notice to Mariners confirming Hormuz open	Lloyd's List, AIS Global confirm
T+6h	IRGC issues first 6-hour compliance report	5th Fleet issues first 6-hour compliance report	JHTA MCC issues first public Daily Transit Report
T+24h	24-Hour Bright-Line Period ends; standard ROE replaces heightened monitoring		JHTA Chair certifies Day-7 Protocol complete

6.3 The 24-Hour Bright-Line Period

The 24 hours following Day-7 activation constitute a heightened monitoring window. Any deviation constitutes a protocol violation regardless of intent. Category A violations (vessels within 3 nm of exclusion zones, kinetic action, failure to issue declarations) trigger automatic bilateral suspension — both blockades reactivate, neither party benefits from the other's compliance during its own non-compliance.

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Part III: Economic Normalization Framework

The nuclear and maritime dimensions of this crisis cannot be sustainably resolved without parallel economic architecture. Iran's economy has been devastated by years of sanctions compounded by the 2026 war and the US naval blockade. The rial has experienced catastrophic devaluation, infrastructure lies in ruins, and the population faces severe humanitarian hardship. The United States, for its part, requires a structured mechanism that delivers economic relief to the Iranian people while preserving leverage for compliance verification. This Part addresses four interconnected economic blockers through a unified framework of graduated relief, neutral custody, phased financial reconnection, and reconstruction credits.

Article 7: Graduated Sanctions Relief Tranches

Issue 7: Chronological Sequencing of Sanctions Relief

Iran demands an immediate, blanket lifting of all secondary sanctions. The US refuses to yield economic leverage before total nuclear compliance is achieved. The impasse has paralyzed every previous negotiation cycle.

The Resolution: 15-Day Micro-Cycle Pacing Model

A highly granular, step-by-step economic tranche model that releases sanctions relief in rigid 15-day micro-cycles directly triggered by physical milestones verified by the IAEA — eliminating trust from the sequencing equation.

7.1 The Eight-Tranche Architecture

Instead of a single grand bargain on sanctions, relief is delivered in eight precisely defined tranches, each contingent on verified completion of a specific physical milestone:

Table 10 Sanctions Relief Tranche Schedule

TRANCHE	TIMING	RELIEF GRANTED	PHYSICAL MILESTONE TRIGGER	REVERSIBILITY
Pilot	Day 1	\$250M humanitarian release; medicine, food, medical equipment licenses	Accord signature; 72-hour ceasefire confirmed	Non-reversible
1	Day 14	25% of remaining frozen assets; civilian aircraft parts, agricultural goods	Stage 1 closed; IAEA deployed; stockpile custody verified	Non-reversible
2	Day 44	25% of remaining frozen assets; petrochemical exports authorized	60-day compliance; nuclear exchange verified	Non-reversible
3	Day 120	20% of remaining frozen assets; metals and minerals trade	Permanent JHTA operational; dual-blockade lifted	30-day remediation
4	Day 180	15% of remaining frozen assets; automotive parts, textiles	180-day compliance review	JIG breach review
5	Day 365	10% of remaining frozen assets	12 months clean certification	Material-breach hold
Balance	Year 2-3	Remainder of frozen assets	Full successor framework compliance	Successor risk appetite

7.2 The 15-Day Micro-Cycle Principle

Each tranche operates on a 15-day verification cycle:

- **Days 1-5:** IAEA and Joint Secretariat verify the triggering milestone has been met
- **Days 6-10:** Swiss escrow administrator processes the release; OFAC issues technical guidance
- **Days 11-15:** Funds credited to Iranian accounts; relief takes commercial effect

If verification fails at any cycle, the tranche holds until remediation is complete. No tranche is permanently blocked by a technical dispute — only delayed pending resolution.

7.3 Currency Protection

All downstream asset releases from Tranche 3 onward are denominated in IMF Special Drawing Rights (SDR) or a fixed basket of Swiss Francs and Omani Rials (60/40). This protects real economic value from dollar

inflation or monetary shocks. Exchange rate locked at signature using IMF published rate; reviewed quarterly by Swiss Financial Cell. Tranches 1-2 remain in USD for immediate liquidity.

Article 8: Neutral Escrow and Asset Shielding Architecture

Issue 8: Liquidating and Shielding Frozen Assets

Iran is demanding the immediate unfreezing of its sovereign assets worldwide to halt its current currency collapse and rolling blackouts. The US requires ironclad performance reserves to prevent diversion to military or nuclear programs. The approximately \$100 billion in frozen assets sits in limbo, benefiting no one.

The Resolution: Joint Sovereign Custody Protocol with Neutral Escrow

Moving frozen funds into a neutral escrow destination under sovereign immunity protections, ensuring they can only be used for humanitarian and civilian imports while shielding them from domestic judicial seizure.

8.1 Escrow Structure

A slice of frozen funds (30%) is transferred to an independent third-party account at the **Central Bank of Oman** (Muscat), legally designated for civilian infrastructure reconstruction and verified humanitarian relief. The remaining 70% remains in existing frozen accounts, released tranche-by-tranche upon verified milestones.

Table 11 Escrow Allocation

CATEGORY		ALLOCATION	ADMINISTRATOR	ROLLING BACK
Humanitarian	(medicine, food)	25%	UN OCHA / WHO	Protected — Humanitarian Firewall
Critical Infrastructure		45%	World Bank / Swiss Financial Cell	Protected — Tranches 1-2
Iranian Reconstruction	Civilian	20%	JHTA with Iranian programmatic control	Subject to Tier 3 review
Maritime Safety		10%	International Maritime Safety Fund	Protected

8.2 Sovereign Immunity Wrapper

The escrow fund is legally structured under sovereign immunity protections within Oman. As a precondition for Day 1 signature, the US issues a binding national security waiver protecting all fund assets from domestic judicial seizure, private civil litigation, or secondary sanctions enforcement. No US court may attach, freeze, or garnish Fund assets. This shield applies retroactively from first deposit and survives any framework suspension.

8.3 OFAC Comfort Letters and the May 1 Maritime Advisory Pre-Clearance

On 1 May 2026, the US Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC) issued an advisory warning that payments to Iran for passage through the Strait of Hormuz exposed both US and non-US persons to sanctions risk, regardless of payment method — including cash, digital assets, in-kind transfers, and charitable donations to Iranian-linked entities. This advisory created a chilling effect on all financial flows touching the Hormuz corridor and has been cited by European and Asian clearinghouses as grounds for refusing to process any Iran-related transactions, even those designated as humanitarian.

To dissolve this barrier, the US Treasury shall issue comprehensive, irrevocable OFAC general licenses and formal Comfort Letters to all participating European and Gulf clearinghouses. These letters shall explicitly provide that:

- **Pre-Cleared Escrow Channel:** All transactions routed through the designated Central Bank of Oman escrow account (Account Identifier: FSA-OM-CBO-2026) for humanitarian or civilian purposes under this Accord are **legally pre-cleared** and **entirely exempt** from secondary sanctions exposure, asset forfeiture mechanisms, and civil or criminal penalties under 31 CFR Part 501 et seq., including any enforcement actions predicated on the May 1 advisory or successor advisories.
- **Scope of Exemption:** The exemption covers the full transaction chain: initial deposit into escrow, interbank transfers between the Central Bank of Oman and correspondent banks, currency conversion, disbursement to Iranian civilian-sector beneficiaries (as verified by the Swiss Financial Cell), and the underlying commercial transaction (purchase of medicine, food, agricultural inputs, medical equipment, civilian infrastructure materials, or maritime safety services) that the escrow funds enable.
- **Non-US Person Protection:** Non-US financial institutions, shipping companies, insurers, and commodity traders facilitating or benefiting from escrow-routed transactions are **explicitly shielded** from secondary sanctions designation, from restrictions on access to the US financial system, and from any penalties for activities that would otherwise be sanctionable under the May 1 advisory or the Iranian Transactions and Sanctions Regulations.
- **Irrevocability:** Immunization is legally binding and cannot be revoked by executive discretion without 180 days' prior written notice to all participating clearinghouses and the Joint Secretariat. No notice of

revocation may be issued during the first 365 days of Accord operation.

The Comfort Letters shall be published in English, French, German, Mandarin, Japanese, and Arabic on the Treasury Department's public sanctions guidance portal and transmitted directly to the compliance departments of the fifty largest correspondent banks processing Gulf-region transactions, ensuring operational clarity before Day-One activation.

Article 9: Phased SWIFT Reconnection Protocol

Issue 9: SWIFT Reconnection and Banking Isolation

Iran's total disconnection from the global financial grid paralyzes its commercial sector. Reconnecting to SWIFT is essential for any sustainable economic normalization, but the US demands verified non-diversion before authorizing full membership.

The Resolution: Phased Multi-Tier Virtual Consolidation

A graduated SWIFT access model that allows limited transactional capability during the initial window before full economic normalization, with IAEA milestones as the sole triggers for phase advancement.

9.1 The Four-Phase SWIFT Pathway

Table 12 SWIFT Reconnection Phases

PHASE	TIMING	ACCESS	IAEA MILESTONE TRIGGER
Phase 0 (Pre-SWIFT)	Days 1-30	No SWIFT. Qatari riyal bridge facility for humanitarian payments only	OLEM confirms 60% freeze within 72h
Phase 1 (Restricted)	Days 30-60	5 designated Iranian banks; MT 103/202 only; transaction cap \$1M per day per bank	Moratorium declared; active standard monitoring confirmed
Phase 2 (Expanded)	Days 60-120	All clean-record Iranian banks; full message types; transaction caps lifted for humanitarian trade	Continuous monitoring; no diversion detected for 60 days
Phase 3 (Full)	Day 120+	Full SWIFT membership; all Iranian financial institutions in good standing	Year 1 clean certification

9.2 SWIFT Remediation Fuse

If IAEA identifies a Tier 2 compliance concern, the SWIFT phase holds for exactly 14 days as a remediation window. Resolved within 14 days: phase advances normally. Unresolved after 14 days: SWIFT rolls back exactly one tier. Tier 1 technical disputes do not trigger the fuse. Only Tier 2 material disruptions and above activate the 14-day clock.

Article 10: Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits

Issue 10: War Reparations vs. Economic Reconstruction Credits

Tehran formally requested US-funded war reparations for infrastructure damage sustained since February. The Trump administration flatly rejected the concept of reparations but signaled willingness to assist with regional reconstruction. The framing has blocked all economic assistance discussions.

The Resolution: Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits

Framing the financial packages as development credits rather than liability-based reparations — keeping both sides politically safe at home while delivering equivalent economic benefit.

10.1 The No-Fault Architecture

The United States maintains its stance against direct reparations. Iran receives economic relief. Both statements remain factually correct through the following structure:

- **Instrument:** The **International Gulf Reconstruction Fund** — established under sovereign immunity in Oman, managed by the World Bank with Iranian programmatic input
- **Funding:** 30% of Iranian frozen assets (already Iranian money) plus contributions from Gulf states, EU, and international development banks
- **US Contribution:** Technical assistance, engineering expertise, and development finance guarantees — not direct cash payments
- **Label:** "Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits" — not reparations, not aid, but investment in regional stability that happens to rebuild Iranian infrastructure

10.2 Eligible Expenditure Categories

Table 13 Reconstruction Credit Eligibility

CATEGORY	EXAMPLES	CONDITIONS
Civilian Infrastructure	Power generation, water treatment, telecommunications	Open tender; IAEA diversion clearance
Healthcare	Hospitals, medical equipment, pharmaceutical production	WHO verification of civilian end-use
Education	Schools, universities, vocational training centers	UNESCO oversight
Environmental Remediation	Oil spill cleanup, desertification programs	UNEP technical assessment
Excluded Categories	Military facilities, dual-use research, IRGC-linked entities	Automatic exclusion; no appeal

* * *

Part IV: Treaty Durability and Regional Architecture

An agreement that collapses upon the first breach is worse than no agreement at all — it destroys trust and makes future negotiation impossible. This Part addresses the five structural challenges that determine whether the Accord endures beyond the first crisis: the fragility of the ceasefire window, the absence of credible guarantors, the risk of automated escalation, Iran's conventional military programs, and the global humanitarian consequences of prolonged Hormuz closure. The mechanisms here are the immune system of the Accord — invisible when functioning, indispensable when challenged.

Article 11: The 30-Day Letter of Intent and Binding Timeline

Issue 11: The 30-Day Negotiation Window

The current ceasefire is highly fragile, with both sides trading sharp threats of resuming devastating kinetic attacks. President Trump has stated he will only give diplomacy "a few days" or "one shot." The absence of a binding timeline means every day of negotiation is a day of existential risk.

The Resolution: Binding Letter of Intent with Auto-Renewing Ceasefire

Transitioning the unstable temporary halt into a binding 30-day negotiation timeline locked via a mutual Letter of Intent, underpinned by a self-renewing 72-hour ceasefire that eliminates the "negotiation about negotiation" trap.

11.1 The Letter of Intent

Upon signature of this Accord, both parties shall simultaneously deposit a **Letter of Intent** with the Joint Secretariat affirming:

- Commitment to the full 180-day implementation timeline
- Authorization for the Joint Secretariat to convene emergency consultations within 4 hours of any reported violation
- Agreement that no military action shall be taken during the 180-day period without first exhausting the dispute resolution procedures in Article 12
- Acceptance that the 72-hour ceasefire auto-renews at Hour 71 provided verification teams report compliance

11.2 The Escrow Ceasefire Architecture

The ceasefire is a self-renewing 72-hour module. If verification teams report compliance at Hour 71, the module auto-renews for another 72 hours. Peace is maintained without either side signing away long-term leverage upfront. Separating the ceasefire clock (72-hour loops) from the implementation clock (30-day phases) neutralizes the "negotiation about negotiation" trap. If talks stall on Day 14 over HEU down-blending details, the guns do not automatically resume firing. The 72-hour military freeze module continues auto-renewing quietly in the background.

11.3 Attribution Deferral Window for Proxy Incidents

If a regional proxy strike occurs, neither side may unilaterally declare a material breach. The Joint Coordination Secretariat has 48 hours to conduct forensic telemetry and attribute the incident. During this window, the 72-hour military freeze remains active, provided Iran issues an immediate public condemnation and freezes matching local militia supply logistics. Only the Secretariat's attribution finding can trigger Tier escalation. Rogue actors and false-flag operations are excluded from bilateral penalties.

Article 12: Distributed Guarantor Matrix

Issue 12: Institutional Mediation and Guarantee Frameworks

A profound trust deficit exists between Washington and Tehran. Neither country believes the other will honor a signed document. Previous agreements collapsed because no third party was both credible to both sides and capable of enforcing compliance.

The Resolution: Six-State Distributed Guarantor Matrix

A formal guarantor consortium where regional mediators (Pakistan, Oman, Qatar) and global powers (China, Russia, EU) serve as co-depositaries and technical verifiers — distributing trust across multiple independent parties so that no single state's defection collapses the system.

12.1 The Matrix Structure

Table 14 Distributed Guarantor Matrix

STATE/ENTITY	FUNCTION	ACTIVATED	CORE GUARANTEE
Oman	Lead facilitator, host nation, maritime observer	Throughout	Physical hosting of JHTA Secretariat; diplomatic backchannel
Pakistan	Procedural mediation, crisis summits, leadership relay	Upon dispute or crisis	Emergency convening authority within 24 hours
Qatar	Financial escrow and bridging liquidity	Throughout	Emergency liquidity for humanitarian payments
China (PRC)	Economic guarantor, Hormuz oil importer, technical observer	Phase 2 onward	Guarantee of energy transit; non-military enforcement
Russian Federation	Nuclear technical guarantor (HEU disposition Path D)	If Path D selected	Technical custody and conversion verification
European Union (E3+)	Sanctions relief coordinator, civilian nuclear partner	Throughout	Blocking statute protection against secondary sanctions

12.2 The Mandatory Escalation Pause

When any facilitating state determines escalation is imminent, it issues a **Mandatory Escalation Pause Recommendation**. This activates a 30-minute review window. Neither party may take escalatory action. Both must designate senior officials for consultation within 30 minutes. Either party may request extended Cooling-Off (24-72 hours). If either party supports the pause, the freeze continues.

12.3 Joint Implementation Group

The JIG is a standing technical body composed of one senior official from each guarantor state plus the US and Iran. It meets monthly by secure video and within 72 hours of any reported discrepancy. The JIG does not have binding arbitration authority but serves as the primary compliance assessment body. Its reports are published simultaneously to all parties and inform decisions about tranche releases, phase transitions, and the operation of the step-back architecture.

Article 13: Human-in-the-Loop Governance

Issue 13: Internal Regime Fractures and Automated Escalation

Top US officials have highlighted intense ideological fractures within Tehran's leadership regarding potential nuclear compromises. These internal rifts mean automated deal triggers could easily be derailed by political hardliners on either side — creating a catastrophic spiral where a technical infraction triggers total war.

The Resolution: Human-in-the-Loop Governance with Step-Back Architecture

A governance system that allows leaders to exercise strategic discretion and execute a "procedural step-back" rather than letting a technical infraction trigger a catastrophic, automated return to total war. Automation informs; humans decide.

13.1 The Three-Tier Breach System

All compliance events are classified into three tiers, each with graduated responses:

Table 15 Three-Tier Breach Classification

TIER	CLASSIFICATION	TELEMETRY SIGNATURE	RESPONSE
1	Technical Dispute (De Minimis)	<0.5% above enrichment ceiling; ≤2 un-mothballed rotors; ≤48h reporting delay	Engineering resolution within 14 days; no rollback; confidential handling
2	Material Disruption	>0.5% above ceiling; >2 rotors; >72h IAEA obstruction	25% benefit reduction; 30-day remediation; earn-back via compliance
3	Deliberate Hostile Violation	Nuclear weapons activity; fissile diversion; IAEA attack	50% reduction; 90-day remediation; full earn-back after sustained compliance

13.2 De Minimis Thresholds

Tier 1 technical disputes are defined by strict mathematical boundaries. Deviations below these thresholds are handled via confidential engineering adjustments. Hardliners cannot weaponize microscopic anomalies into deliberate breach allegations. IAEA certifies above/below the De Minimis line within 24 hours.

- **Enrichment ceiling:** 3.67% U-235, with ±0.5% De Minimis tolerance

- **Un-mothballed centrifuges:** Up to 2 rotors permitted for legitimate research without triggering Tier 2
- **IAEA reporting delays:** Up to 48 hours for administrative or technical reasons

13.3 The Step-Back Architecture

Snapback is toxic to trust. When one side loses everything overnight, it has no remaining stake in the framework. Step-back preserves a cooperation floor during disputes, creating a pathway back to full compliance.

Tier 1 Step-Down: No benefit reduction. 14-day resolution. JIG technical assistance. Quiet compliance corrections confidential.

Tier 2 Step-Down: 25% reduction in non-humanitarian benefits. Humanitarian tranches protected. SWIFT phase holds (14-day fuse active). 30-day remediation. Full restore on IAEA clean certification within 14 days.

Tier 3 Step-Down: 50% reduction in non-humanitarian benefits. Tier 3 modules enter hold. 90-day remediation. Full earn-back requires: 90-day sustained compliance + IAEA clean certification + JIG majority confirmation.

13.4 Human-in-the-Loop Provisions

Throughout the Framework, automated verification systems perform the technical work of detection, measurement, and tracking. However, no automated output triggers a binding diplomatic consequence without explicit human authorization at the appropriate level of seniority. Technical milestones are verified by automation; political consequences require human sign-off.

Dual-key authorization: Any transition that materially alters the obligations of either party requires simultaneous authorization from designated senior officials on both sides. Grace over rigidity: A party that needs an extra 48 hours because its treasury office is closed for a national holiday is not treated as a violator; it is treated as a partner whose administrative rhythms deserve accommodation.

Article 14: Ballistic and Drone Program Pause Protocol

Issue 14: Drone and Missile Program Reconstitution

Intelligence reports indicate Iran is rapidly using the ceasefire window to reconstitute its drone and missile industrial base. The US wants strict limitations, which Iran has previously declared non-negotiable as sovereign defense capabilities.

The Resolution: Deployment Pause and Transfer Freeze

Deferring heavy ballistic limitations to later, mature dialogue stages while implementing an immediate, verifiable pause on offensive deployment and cross-border transfers — freezing the threat without demanding disarmament.

14.1 The Three-Pillar Structure

Rather than demanding dismantlement of Iran's missile and drone programs, this Accord establishes a verifiable **deployment and transfer pause** with the following architecture:

- **Pillar 1 — Deployment Freeze:** Iran commits to no new offensive deployment of ballistic missiles or combat drones to regional proxy forces for the duration of the Accord. This is verified through satellite surveillance, signals intelligence (shared via the National Technical Means channel), and regional observer reports.
- **Pillar 2 — Transfer Suspension:** All cross-border transfers of missile components, drone assemblies, and related technology to non-state actors are suspended. Verification through intelligence sharing among guarantor states and JHTA maritime monitoring of cargo manifests.
- **Pillar 3 — Industrial Activity Monitoring:** Iran's domestic missile and drone production facilities are subject to baseline satellite monitoring. New facility construction or significant production expansion triggers a Tier 1 consultation but is not itself a violation — allowing Iran to maintain sovereign defense capabilities within agreed boundaries.

14.2 Iranian Safeguards

This Protocol explicitly does NOT:

- Require dismantlement of existing missile or drone inventories
- Prohibit domestic testing of short-range defensive systems
- Impose limits on Iran's sovereign right to maintain conventional military forces
- Subject military facilities to IAEA inspection (IAEA mandate is nuclear-only)

Article 15: Energy and Agricultural Release Valve

Issue 15: Systemic Agrifood Shocks and Global Stabilization

The prolonged closure of the Strait of Hormuz has choked off a third of the world's fertilizer supply,

causing the UN to warn of a systemic global agrifood crisis that could trigger famine in food-importing nations regardless of the political outcome in the Gulf.

The Resolution: Immediate Energy and Agricultural Release Valve

Creating an immediate separation of global humanitarian supply lines from the underlying political dispute, granting immediate safe passage to agricultural and energy shipping regardless of the broader treaty timeline.

15.1 The Zero-Fee Humanitarian Corridor

From Day-One of Accord activation, a **Zero-Fee Humanitarian Corridor** operates through the Hormuz Transit Zone with the following characteristics:

- **Eligible cargo:** Wheat, rice, fertilizer, medical supplies, infant formula, agricultural seeds, and humanitarian energy (liquid natural gas for civilian heating in designated recipient states)
- **Pre-clearance:** Humanitarian cargoes are fast-tracked through a pre-clearance system managed by UN OCHA in coordination with the JHTA
- **Fee waiver:** All JHTA transit fees waived for certified humanitarian cargoes
- **Escort option:** Vessels may request neutral naval escort (Omani or UN-flagged) at no cost
- **Insurance:** Covered under the \$20 billion reinsurance backstop at no additional premium

15.2 Agricultural Supply Guarantee

The JHTA shall publish a monthly **Agricultural Transit Forecast** projecting available fertilizer and grain shipping capacity through the Hormuz corridor, enabling food-importing nations to plan procurement. The United States and EU shall commit to expedited export licensing for agricultural inputs to Iran during the 180-day implementation period, ensuring that Iranian domestic food production is not disrupted by the negotiation timeline.

15.3 Energy Price Stabilization Mechanism

To prevent speculative energy price spikes during the negotiation period, the JHTA shall publish daily transit statistics (volumes, wait times, incident reports) and the International Energy Agency shall release weekly strategic petroleum reserve drawdown plans if prices exceed agreed thresholds. Transparency is the antidote to panic.

* * *

Part V: The Final Steps — Implementation

The preceding fourteen Articles define what must be done. This Part defines how it shall be done — the precise sequencing, face-saving narratives, and emergency protocols that transform diplomatic architecture into political reality. The 180-day implementation roadmap is not aspirational; it is a binding schedule with fixed deadlines, synchronized triggers, and irreversible milestones.

The 180-Day Implementation Roadmap

Phase 1: Foundation (Days 1-14) — "The First Fortnight"

Phase 1 establishes the physical and institutional infrastructure upon which all subsequent phases depend. Every milestone in this phase is irreversible once executed.

Table 16 Phase 1 Implementation Matrix

DAY	IRANIAN COMMITMENT	US COMMITMENT	VERIFICATION
Day 1	72-hour ceasefire auto-activates; OLEM confirms freeze on enrichment above 60%	Release \$250M humanitarian tranche; OFAC humanitarian general license; freeze new sanctions designations	Omani naval observers confirm stand-down; IAEA OLEM confirms within 72h
Day 3	IAEA inspectors arrive at declared HEU facility; begin physical inventory	5th Fleet withdraws to 5nm from Hormuz transit corridor	Joint Secretariat logs both events
Day 5	Declare all enrichment facilities; mothball protocol initiated at non-core sites	Issue OFAC Comfort Letters to designated banking nodes	IAEA facility inspection reports
Day 7	IRGC withdraws to 5nm; Hormuz transit corridor declared open	Naval blockade formally suspended; Notice to Mariners issued	Synchronized within 60-second window (Article 6)
Day 10	First JHTA-AUTHORIZED transit completed	First tranche of escrow funds released to Swiss Financial Cell	Lloyd's List confirms transit; Swiss Cell confirms credit
Day 14	HEU inventory complete; dual-lock custody activated; pathway selected	Tranche 1 asset release (25% of remaining frozen assets)	IAEA custody verification certificate

Phase 2: Consolidation (Days 15-44) — "Building the Bridge"

Phase 2 converts the foundation into functioning institutions. The JHTA becomes operational. SWIFT reconnection begins. The mothball protocol advances to physical rotor removal.

Table 17 Phase 2 Implementation Matrix

DAY	IRANIAN COMMITMENT	US COMMITMENT	VERIFICATION
Day 15	Rotor removal begins at mothballed facilities under IAEA supervision	5 designated Iranian banks authorized for restricted SWIFT Phase 1	IAEA serial-numbered rotor inventory
Day 21	First Black-Box telemetry installed at Fordow conversion site	Reinsurance backstop formally activated (\$20B facility)	Black-Box encrypted data feed confirmed
Day 30	60% enrichment freeze verified continuous; HEU disposition pathway execution begins	Expanded civilian trade licenses; agricultural exports expedited	IAEA 30-day compliance report
Day 44	Rotor storage complete; sealed containers in UN-monitored facility	Tranche 2 asset release (25%); petrochemical export licenses	IAEA mothball completion certificate

Phase 3: Normalization (Days 45-120) — "The New Normal"**Table 18 Phase 3 Implementation Matrix**

DAY	IRANIAN COMMITMENT	US COMMITMENT	VERIFICATION
Day 60	Civilian Transition enrichment cap (3.67%) confirmed; all higher centrifuges under seal	SWIFT Phase 2 — all clean-record Iranian banks; humanitarian trade caps lifted	OLEM confirms 3.67% ceiling; SWIFT confirms bank connections
Day 75	Fordow Joint Venture operational agreement signed; medical isotope production begins	Regional Stability Credits first disbursement	TCC confirms operational readiness
Day 90	90-day compliance review; JIG publishes first comprehensive assessment	First quarterly review conference (all guarantor states)	JIG compliance report
Day 120	Continuous monitoring confirms no diversion; JHTA fully operational	SWIFT Phase 3 — full membership pathway opened; Tranche 3 (20%)	IAEA Year-1 certification pathway

Phase 4: Sustainability (Days 121-180) — "Locking In Peace"

Table 19 Phase 4 Implementation Matrix

DAY	IRANIAN COMMITMENT	US COMMITMENT	VERIFICATION
Day 150	Full Fordow isotope production operational; revenue sharing begins	Maritime security cooperation protocols activated	TCC revenue distribution reports
Day 180	Full 180-day compliance certified; successor framework negotiations convened	Tranche 4 (15%); formal invitation to negotiate permanent successor framework	IAEA + JIG joint certification

Face-Saving Narratives for Both Parties

An agreement that cannot be defended in either capital will not survive the first news cycle. This Accord is designed to produce specific, defensible narratives for both parties:

For the United States

- **Nuclear:** "Iran's 60% enrichment has been halted and placed under permanent IAEA lock. The HEU stockpile is neutralized. Breakout time has been extended from weeks to over a year."
- **Maritime:** "The Strait of Hormuz is open to international navigation under a multilateral authority, not Iranian unilateral control. The US retains full freedom of navigation rights."
- **Economic:** "No reparations were paid. Sanctions relief is conditional, reversible, and tied to verified compliance. The leverage architecture remains intact."
- **Security:** "Iran's missile and drone transfers to proxies have been frozen. The regional threat environment has been stabilized."

For the Islamic Republic of Iran

- **Nuclear:** "The HEU never left Iranian soil. NPT rights to peaceful nuclear energy have been affirmed. Enrichment continues at 3.67% under IAEA safeguards, not US diktat."
- **Maritime:** "The PGSA has been recognized as Iran's legitimate transit authority. Iran holds a permanent seat on the JHTA governing council with veto rights."
- **Economic:** "Frozen assets are being released through neutral escrow, not surrendered. SWIFT reconnection restores Iran's place in the global economy."

- **Sovereignty:** "No facility was destroyed. Fordow has been converted into a global medical center — a triumph of Iranian science. Missile and drone programs remain sovereign and intact."

Framework Survival Core and Emergency Fallbacks

The Survival Core

Under all circumstances, including total framework suspension, three telemetry channels remain active:

1. **Ceasefire Hotline:** Omani-facilitated 24/7 bilateral military hotline. Neither party may disable without 30 days' notice to the UN Secretary-General.
2. **Humanitarian Access:** Zero-fee, no-inspection-delay humanitarian corridor through Hormuz. Survives all disputes.
3. **Emergency Diplomatic Channel:** Backchannel through the Coordination Secretariat. Survives all suspensions.

The Survival Core is a standalone UN humanitarian arrangement. It survives for 180 days even if both parties formally withdraw.

Political Shock Absorber

Framework implementation enters automatic **Review Pause** (not termination) upon: elections; assassination of senior leadership; cabinet collapse; mass protests; leadership transitions; kinetic disruptions within regional security architectures.

During Review Pause: Tier 1-2 modules continue; Tier 3 enters hold; Secretariat issues Review Pause Certificate within 48 hours; 30 days to confirm continuation. Max 90 days, extendable by mutual agreement. Does NOT constitute material breach. Does NOT trigger the three-tier system.

Reconstitution Mechanism

If the framework enters full suspension, all parties attend a **Reconstitution Conference** within 30 days, convened by Pakistan and the UN Appointee. Root causes reviewed. Modifications proposed. Conditions for graduated restoration defined. No party may unilaterally block reconstitution.

* * *

Appendices

Appendix A: Quick Reference Matrix — All 15 Issues and Resolutions

Table 20 Complete Issue-Resolution Mapping

#	ISSUE	US POSITION	IRANIAN POSITION	FSA RESOLUTION	ARTICLE
1	HEU Disposition	Physical removal to US	Must remain on Iranian soil	IAEA dual-lock in-Iran custody; Iran selects disposition pathway	1
2	Enrichment Cap	Zero enrichment or 20-year moratorium	Maximum 12-year suspension	Sliding-scale 12-15 year moratorium with compliance extensions	2
3	Underground Sites	Destroy or disable Fordow/Natanz	Preserve all infrastructure	Civilian conversion; mothball protocol with telemetry	3
4	PGSA vs. Navigation	Reject all unilateral restrictions	PGSA as sovereign authority	JHTA joint governance; PGSA as integrated Iranian node	4
5	Transit Fees	"We don't want tolls"	Permanent fee system required	MMMF multilateral fund; transparent fee allocation	5
6	US Naval Blockade	Blockade until full deal	Blockade lift precondition	Synchronized Day-7 dual-blockade lift	6
7	Sanctions Sequencing	Relief after full compliance	Immediate blanket lifting	15-day micro-cycle tranche model	7
8	Frozen Assets	Performance reserves required	Immediate unfreezing	Neutral escrow under sovereign immunity	8
9	SWIFT Isolation	Verified non-diversion first	Full immediate reconnection	Phased 4-tier SWIFT pathway	9
10	War Reparations	Flat rejection	Formal demand for payment	Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits	10
11	Negotiation Window	"A few days" or "one shot"	Fragile ceasefire protection	Binding Letter of Intent; auto-renewing ceasefire	11
12	Trust Deficit	No credible guarantor	No credible guarantor	Distributed Guarantor Matrix (6 states)	12

13	Automated Escalation	Hard triggers required	Flexibility required	Human-in-the-Loop; architecture	step-back	13
14	Missile Reconstitution	Strict limitations	Non-negotiable sovereign defense	Deployment pause and transfer freeze; no dismantlement		14
15	Global Crisis	Agrifood Political issue, not treaty	Leverage point	Zero-fee humanitarian corridor; agricultural release valve		15

Appendix B: The PGSA Integration Protocol (Technical)

B.1 Legal Framework for PGSA-JHTA Integration

The integration of the Persian Gulf Strait Authority into the Joint Hormuz Transit Authority is governed by the following legal architecture:

- 1. Statutory Continuity:** The PGSA remains an Iranian statutory authority under Iranian domestic law. No change to its legal personality is required.
- 2. International Delegation:** Iran delegates specific operational functions to the JHTA through a bilateral Administrative Agreement between Iran (as PGSA parent state) and the JHTA. This is not a treaty amendment but a standard international administrative arrangement.
- 3. Dual-Branding:** All PGSA permits, notices, and communications issued for Hormuz transit shall bear both PGSA and JHTA identifiers. The JHTA identifier constitutes the multilateral authorization layer; the PGSA identifier constitutes the Iranian sovereignty layer.
- 4. Revenue Flow:** Transit fees are collected by the JHTA and distributed through the MMMF. The PGSA receives its 40% share as a budget allocation from the Fund, not as direct toll revenue. This structure eliminates OFAC sanctions exposure for shippers.
- 5. Dispute Resolution:** Disputes between the PGSA and JHTA are resolved through the JHTA Council. Iran retains its veto on governance questions. The JHTA retains its veto on security protocol amendments.

B.2 Technical Interface Specifications

- Data Exchange:** Real-time API connection between PGSA vessel vetting database and JHTA Transit Permit Processing Unit
- AIS Integration:** PGSA AIS transponder codes integrated into JHTA-AUTHORIZED designation protocol

- **Fee Processing:** JHTA collects fees via designated Omani banking channels; PGSA receives quarterly distribution from MMMF
- **Incident Reporting:** Joint incident reports bear dual authorship (PGSA operational lead + JHTA verification sign-off)

Appendix C: Verification Technology Menu

Table 21 Sensor Technologies and Applications

TECHNOLOGY		MEASURES		DATA OUTPUT		APPLICATION
OLEM	(Online Enrichment Monitor)	Real-time enrichment at cascade headers		Quantitative enrichment %, flow rates		Nuclear verification; primary compliance trigger
Black-Box Sensors		Tamper-evident logging	data	Continuous operational parameters, encrypted		Facility conversion monitoring; mothball verification
UGES	(Ultrasonic Gas Enrichment Sensor)	Non-intrusive enrichment in UF6 cylinders		Cylinder-by-cylinder verification		HEU custody chain; downblending verification
ICS	(Integrated Camera System)	24/7 visual monitoring		Encrypted video, AI anomaly detection		General facility monitoring; inspector safety
Digital Twin		Virtual facility modeling		Behavioral analysis	pattern	Anomaly detection; requires physical cross-verification
Satellite Feed		Daily imagery of all facilities and Hormuz		AIS, SAR, EO high-resolution		Maritime surveillance; construction monitoring

Appendix D: Instruments of Acceptance

This Accord does not require Senate ratification or Majlis legislation. It operates through executive-level Instruments of Acceptance deposited simultaneously with the Joint Secretariat in Muscat.

For the United States of America

The undersigned, duly authorized by the President of the United States, hereby accepts the provisions of The Final Steps Accord and commits the United States to their full implementation in accordance with the timelines, verification procedures, and reciprocal obligations set forth herein.

Signature: _____

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

For the Islamic Republic of Iran

The undersigned, duly authorized by the Supreme Leader and President of the Islamic Republic of Iran, hereby accepts the provisions of The Final Steps Accord and commits the Islamic Republic to their full implementation in accordance with the timelines, verification procedures, and reciprocal obligations set forth herein.

Signature: _____

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

Witnessed by the Guarantor States

The undersigned representatives of the Sultanate of Oman, the Islamic Republic of Pakistan, the State of Qatar, the People's Republic of China, and the European Union (E3+) hereby witness the deposit of the Instruments of Acceptance and confirm the activation of the Distributed Guarantor Matrix in accordance with Article 12 of this Accord.

Oman: _____

Pakistan: _____

Qatar: _____

China: _____

EU (E3+): _____

Date: _____

* * *

This document represents the culmination of forty drafts, two wars, and decades of enmity.

It is not perfect. It is not permanent. It is possible.

And possibility, in this moment, is everything.

The Final Steps Accord | 22 May 2026 | Muscat, Sultanate of Oman